

Sultant Of Oman
Ministry of Health
Royal Hospital



سلطنة عمان
وزارة الصحة
المستشفى السلطاني

Document Management System



Sultanate of Oman
Ministry of Health
The Royal Hospital
Department of Medical Supplies

Code: MS-POL-4-Vers.1.1

Effective Date: 15/10/2019

Target Review Date: 01/01/2021

Title: POLICY &PROCEDURE - DISASTER /EMERGENCY PREPAREDNESS PLAN

DISASTER AND EMERGENCY PREPAREDNESS PLAN

SECTION 1

INTRODUCTION

A disaster is defined as a serious disruption of the functioning of the society, causing wide spread human, material, or environmental losses which exceed the ability of the affected society to cope using its own resources.” Disasters are unpredictable and therefore are difficult to prepare.

HOW CAN WE REDUCE THE RISK

Preparedness: Includes all those measures taken before a disaster event which are aimed at minimizing loss of life, disruption of critical services when the disaster occurs. Thus, preparedness is a protective process which enables departments to respond rapidly to disaster situation. Preparedness includes development of emergency response plans, effective warning systems, maintenance of inventories, staff training etc

Departments of Medical Supplies is responsible for handling procurement, storage distribution of drugs and consumables. Unique expertise essential in managing the supply chain to ensure effective distribution of medications and other items uninterruptedly. As part of the plan, department of Medical Supplies should always well prepared for a possible disaster.

DEFINITIONS:

Internal disaster:

Any incidents that threaten the safety of patients, visitors, staff or the physical structure of the hospital. Examples include

Emergency Response Team (ERT):

physician on duty if there is suspected casualties.

HOSPITAL OPERATION CENTER HOC:

The location from where the hospital administration directs and controls the hospital operations during external or internal emergency.

UNIT PREPARATION FOR INTERNAL DISASTER

- Director of the Medical Supplies will be the Focal person. He/she should assign each unit (Medical, Surgical, Lab and Receiving section) to ensure that the unit specific preparedness plan sheet is filled, clearly displayed and all staff are aware of the contents.
- All emergency call numbers should be clearly displayed in the working area, preferably near each telephone.
- A staff call-out plan should be ready and accessible for each unit
- The evacuation plan should be clearly displayed in each corridor of each unit.

STAFF TRAINING AND DRILLS:

- All units in department of Medical Supplies should ensure that all staff are educated in the internal disaster plan. This includes procedures to be followed in case of a fire or smoke occur in their work place. All new staff should be trained as part of their orientation and annual refresher training and drills will be scheduled .
- All staff in the department shall be familiar with the fire and evacuation procedure and be aware of the locations of fire alarms, extinguishers, fire exits and evacuation routes for their work area.
- Department should participate in the fire and evacuation drill as scheduled by the safety officers.
- Department must keep a log book of all training and drills conducted.

PLAN ORGANIZATION

The internal disaster plan should be organized with general response instructions that all staff members of the department can follow in case of all internal incidents

PLAN ACTIVATION

If internal events are short duration and have low impact can be dealt by the staff in the affected area with coordination with seniors. The hospital internal disaster plan will be activated when an incident may occur or occurred and that the impact is likely to disrupt normal hospital operations. eg: fire, smoke, potential exposure to hazardous materials, flooding or structural damage to the facility etc.

GENERAL APPROACH AND EMERGENCY RESPONSE STEPS

In the event of suspected emergency like fire or chemical spillage, the in-charge of the unit should be informed. After quick initial assessment, she/ he should inform the department The Emergency response Team. After assessing the situation, the ERT might seek assistance and guidance from specialized hospital staff like engineering or fire officer depending on the type of the incident.

ACTIVATE HOSPITAL OPERATION CENTER – HOC

Hospital operation center should be activated when a disaster/event exceeds the resources of a department or have operational impact on department's daily work. If the situation requires response from civil defense, then they will assume command of the scene once arrived.

STAFF ROLES DURING INTERNAL DISASTER

- All on duty staff should assume their usual duties unless instructed otherwise by the management team. They should not leave their station or try to call the affected site.
- It is the responsibility of all staff to make sure that their details are correct in the call out list of the department. They should be aware of the evacuation procedure in the unit as well.

MEDIA CONTROL DURING AND AFTER INCIDENT

material without administration approval. All inquiries should be redirected to the hospital information desk. The hospital information desk will be established and managed by the PRO.

INCIDENT DEBRIEFING

After each actual activation or exercise, a debriefing session should be arranged by the command post. The debriefing and counseling session should include all the staff involved.

SECTION TWO

POLICY

The Royal Hospital shall have in place at all times a coded system to be initiated in the event of any confirmed fire incident. **CODE RED**, hospital's emergency code, to initiate a response in the event of a FIRE. A notification of “Code Red” alerts hospital personnel to respond properly in the incident of a fire from undue panic. Staff is required to know and adhere department’s fire response plan/ procedures and follow any additional instructions that are announced. Periodic briefing/training should be conducted for the staff for facing an emergency. Royal Hospital's fire emergency telephone extension number for code red is **9777**.

OBJECTIVE

The objective is to provide on a permanent 24 hours selected “On Duty” team or managers or otherwise competent persons to respond in the event of a confirmed outbreak of fire in the department. The team shall be known as the **CODE RED TEAM** and shall respond immediately to the location of an occurrence of fire in order to bring authority and take control of the incident.

1. CODE RED TEAM MEMBERS

The Code Red Team shall be as follows:

- ***During Normal Working Hours:***

Director of Medical supplies

Head, Medical stores,

Head, Receiving Section

Duty Director

Fire Officer

- ***Outside normal working hours:***

Director of Medical supplies

Head, Medical stores,

Head, Receiving Section

Duty Director

- Outside normal working hours the code red team shall respond to assess the severity of the incident. The code red team having assessed the severity of the incident shall make the decision whether or not to place a call to the Civil Defense Fire & Rescue Services.
- The decision to call the Civil Defense Fire & Rescue Services shall be based solely upon whether or not the fire is in progress and if it is within or beyond the control of staff on duty in using safety equipments provided.
- In such circumstances where an evacuation is required, the code red team shall organize and supervise a progressive evacuation process.

2. PREPARE FOR AN EMERGENCY

- Department heads of Medical & MSL Stores to ensure that all staff are trained in emergency procedures and aware of their responsibilities. Regularly review and update current staff and emergency contacts. Regularly review the location of back-up emergency equipment. Ensure all staff likely to act in case of an emergency and understand their responsibilities. Review the availability of possible alternative locations annually, or earlier if changes to building management or usage occur. Ensure that all staff participate in a minimum of one emergency management exercise per year. Document the outcomes of these exercises, the improvements identified and the plan to achieve them.

3. ARRANGEMENTS FOR ALERTING THE CODE RED TEAM MEMBERS.

- Information that a fire incident may possibly be in progress shall be received as an electronic signal by the hospital switchboard operator at the fire alarm panel, and / or by the maintenance operator via the duct systems.
- Information confirming that a fire is actually in progress shall be received by the switchboard operator via the Code Red fire emergency extension 9777. Switchboard operator shall record the location, the name of the caller and details of the fire etc.
- Information received shall be forwarded immediately to the Fire Officer. The Fire Officer shall respond immediately and give instruction to operator to alert code red team.
- The switchboard operator shall immediately alert the code red team members by duct phone announcing the location of the incident
- The switchboard operator shall make an announcement via the hospital microphone system as follows: “**Code Red, Code Red, Code Red**”. - Code Red team of the must rush immediately to the location.
- Once the announcement has been made the switchboard operator shall remain vigilant in order to receive or dispatch further information.

FIRE EMERGENCY (CODE RED)

1. FIRE OR SMOKE IN YOUR AREA

- Do not panic, Shout “FIRE” and summon the assistance of others in your area.
- Raise the alarm by breaking the glass at the nearest fire alarm call point.
Dial the fire emergency ext., 9777 and notify the operator of your exact location .Fire in _____, Room , Unit
- If it is safe to do so, attempt to extinguish the fire.
- If the fire is out of control, prepare to evacuate. Follow the department's evacuation plan.
- Attempt to close all doors and switch off electrical items as you leave.
- Follow instructions of person in charge of your area.
- Alert all staff and customers if any, and evacuate from the area of immediate danger
- Close doors and windows in your area. Ensure that hallway doors are closed.
Prepare for evacuation:

Guidelines:

- **Keep fire tools clear:** These include fire extinguishers, sprinklers and automatic fire detection systems. all employees should have an easy access to an extinguisher.
- **Storage Arrangements:** Crowded aisles may block fire exits and make it harder for people to escape, also the crowded materials can cause fire spread more easily. The height of the stored material should not exceed 1 meter below the ceiling.
- **storage of combustible materials:** Ensure you have enough storage areas for your needs and ensure storage areas are adequately controlled and monitored.
- **Smoking:** to comply with legislation, you must prohibit smoking throughout your storeroom area.
- **Waste Removal:** Accumulating waste in the storeroom is a major fire risk. Staff should remove all waste materials at the end of every working day and transfer them to external area. Fire escape route should be free of any obstacles.

Actions on Discovering a Fire

Anybody discovering a fire must: -

- **Raise the alarm:** Break the glass on a fire alarm call point.
- **Move the Staff** from immediate danger.
- **Get out and close (but not lock) the door behind you:** this will contain the fire and smoke in one area.
- **Report to the In-Charge** and give information about the fire to department in Charge. The in Charge needs to phone the fire Code on (9777) and give the following specific information: -

Name of Person Calling:

Post or Title:

Dept contact no:

Information about the fire: Where/What is on fire/Small / Large/ Smell of Burning /Unknown.

Evacuation: Taking place/No evacuation.

- **Move people to safety:** the in charge needs to start evacuating the staff from store.
- The in charge to decide on which access doors leading to outside the Store. (Remember that any technical equipment used to move patients should only be used by those trained in their use.)
- **Tackle the fire if safe to do so:** Send staff to fight the fire if staff are available and it is safe to do so until the Fire Officer and Civil Defence reach the location.(Remember that the fire officer on duty will take at least 3 minutes to arrive).
- **Go to the fire assembly point:** Move quickly, safely and quietly.
 - Take a roll call to ensure all staff and carers are present.
 - If all are not present reports to Fire Officer, the number of persons missing and where last seen.

Actions on Hearing the Fire Alarm

On hearing the alarm staff must: -

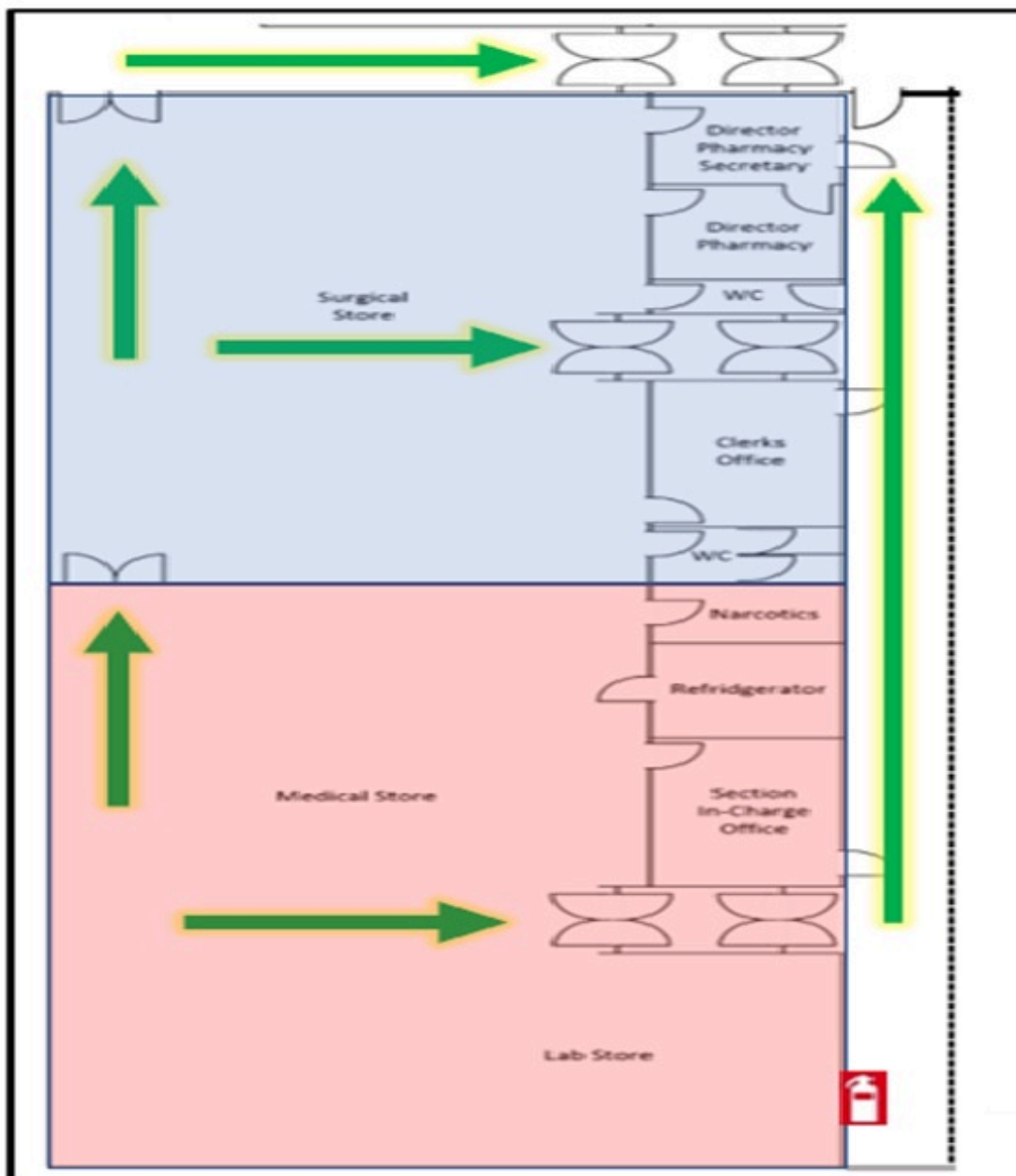
- Remain calm.
- All staff should recognise the sound.
 - If the alarm sound is continuous, it means that there is a fire in your area.
 - If the sound is intermittent the fire is in a nearby area.
- The Department in Charge should return to the nurse station immediately.
- All staff should report to the person in charge.
- If staff find the fire when on the way to the nurse station, they should:
 - Gather information of the fire.
 - Then close the door to fire area if possible.
 - Report to the person in charge with the information.
- If the fire is not immediately visible:

Emergency numbers:

- 9777 - Local Emergency Number
- 3024 / 9511 - Fire Safety Officer
- 9512 - Control Room

3. EVACUATION PLAN (MEDICAL & MSL STORES)

- Emergency evacuation is the immediate and urgent movement of people away from the threat or actual occurrence of a hazard.
- Medical stores :There are two emergency fire exits in stores – One in Surgical stores and one in Medical stores
- MSL (Receiving) stores: There are THREE fire exits in MSL stores.
- All staff must be trained on proper and safe evacuation. Each unit should have emergency evacuation plan and the plan should be practiced twice annually.
- If time permits, the specialized hospital staff should be called to the site. If at any time, there is immediate danger to staff, then prepare for evacuation immediately.
- Exits which lead to the outside of stores or to follow the emergency exit signs to evacuate to outside the building
- Assembly point will be near the roundabout, outside of the building near the **Gate no1**.



4. RELOCATION :

Relocation is a complex undertaking which has risks of its own. It may be short term, but if the main premises are damaged then expect the relocation may need for longer period.

- **Cold room Items:** Since the temperature control of cold rooms in the medical stores are linked to engineering department, medical stores to liaise with engineering department and act accordingly to transfer items if needed. Refrigerators available in the pharmacies to be monitored frequently by the Pharmacy staff and report to in-charges. If power outages is for a longer period, seek help from DGMS or Suppliers to shift all cold room items to their facility.
- Director of Medical supplies to liaise with DGMS and suppliers like Muscat Pharmacy, Taiba pharmacy to use their cold room facility and transfer all items as soon as possible.
- **Contact numbers:**

DGMS - (Ph. Hamad Al Mahrazi - 94200012)

Taiba Pharmacy - (Ph. Khalid Al Zadjali - 99335823)

Muscat Pharmacy - (Mr.Ashish - 99461030)

- In the event of an evacuation and complete shutdown of operations from medical stores, service to hospital departments will be continued from MSL Stores.

5. EMERGENCY PREPAREDNESS:

STRATEGIC NATIONAL STORE (BAUSER)

A reserve store containing lifesaving drugs and pharmaceuticals are maintained by Directorate General of Medical Supplies (DGMS) with a stock value of R.O. 4.5 million in Wilayat of Bauser (near to Bauser polyclinic). All vital items are stored as a preventive strategic measure to meet any kind of emergencies or natural calamities. Director of Medical Supplies, Royal Hospital should liaise with DGMS, for using that buffer stock. Refer to MoH policy for more details (available in the office of the Director of Medical Supplies). *Contact number # Ph. Hamad Al Mahrazi -94200012*

Director and in-charges may contact other institutions to arrange required items:

Contact Numbers:

- Directorate General of Stores (DGMS) - *Ph. Hamad Al Mahrazi - 94200012*
- Sultan Qaboos University Hospital (SQUH) - *Ph. Haitham -96355779*
- Armed Forces Hospital(AFH) - *Ph. Malik - 99808399*
- Royal Oman Police Hospital (ROPH) - *Ph. Paul -99443264*
- Other MoH Hospitals in the capital area.
- Tawam Hospital (UAE) -

POWER OUTAGES:

Department should be well prepared for the storage of items in the event of power outages. Adequate measures to be taken to ensure drugs and chemicals especially items to be stored in refrigerator are transferred to an area with controlled temperature and cold room facility.

1. Backup power supply –Generator:

Department of engineering to ensure power supply through backup generator in the event of power failure. Department of Medical supplies to liaise with engineering department and take necessary steps to transfer the stock to a place where there is a controlled temperature facility available (contact Control room # 9512)

2. Computer shut down:

available for emergency use.

3. Procurement / receiving of items

Purchase Department to use issue manual order confirmation/LPO for procuring of drugs and consumables for emergency and the receipts to be taken manually as well. A register to be maintained to record for the items ordered and received manually.

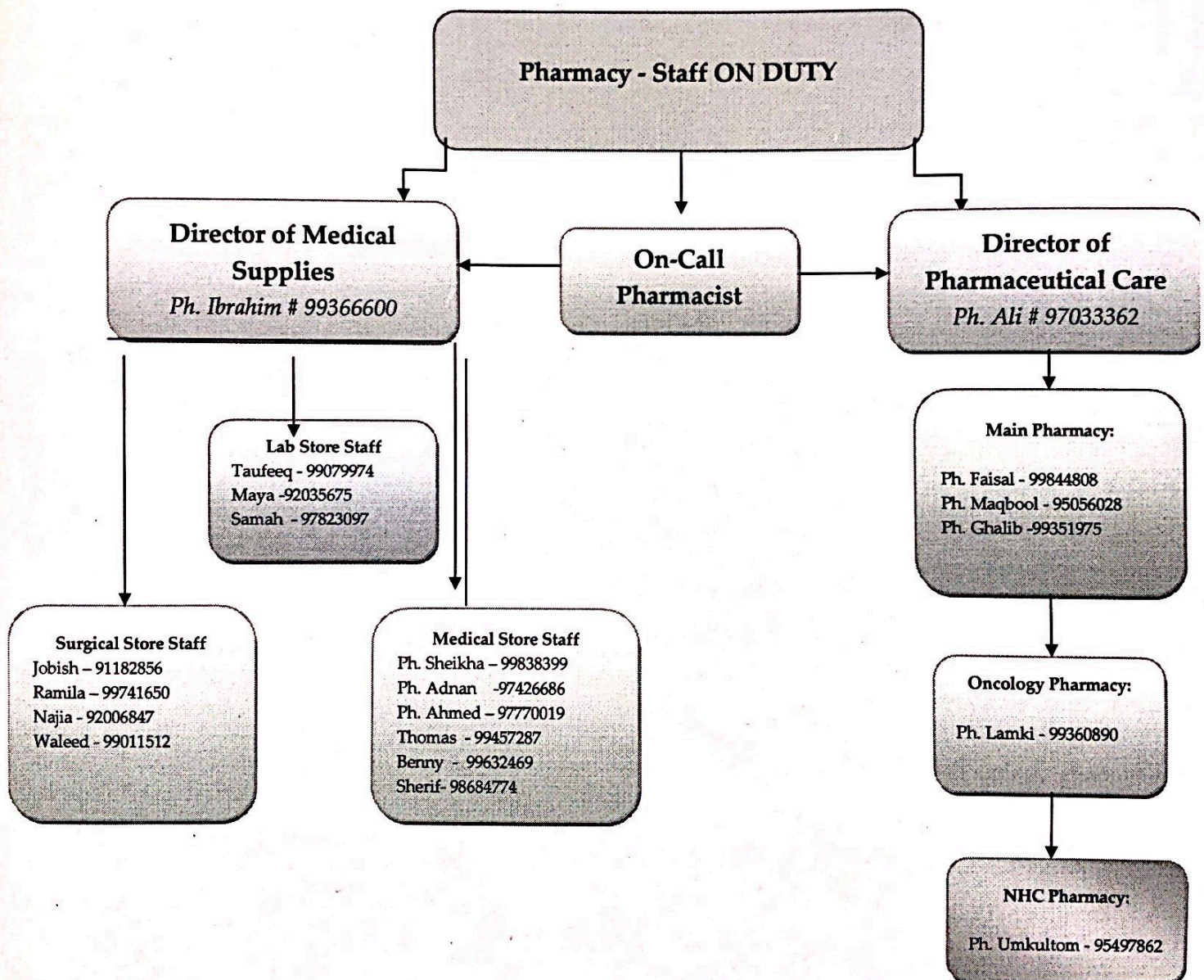
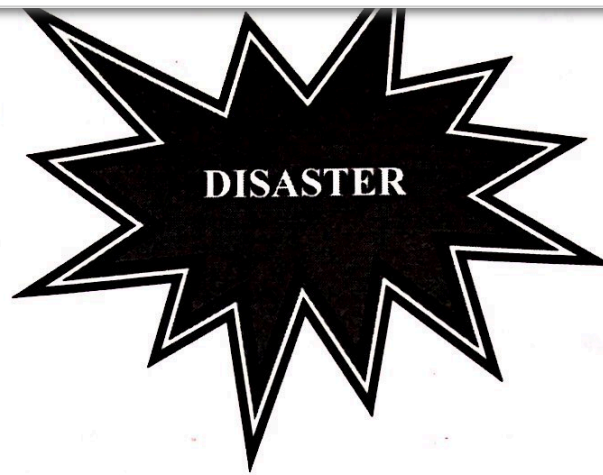
STAFF CONTACT NUMBERS:

Sl	Name	Position	Address	Email	Telephone
1	Ph.Ibrahim Al Rashdi	Director	Rusail		99366600
2	Ph. Sheikha Al Harthi	Head, Medical Stores	Seeb		99838399
3	Ph. Adnan Al Qassabi	Head, MSL Stores	Al Ansab		95188175
4	Ph. Ahmed Al Salmi	Pharmacist, Medical Stores	Seeb		97770019
5	Ph. Hassan Al Ajmi	Pharmacist, MSL	Seeb		99284870
6	Ramila Patil	Staff Nurse	Seeb		99741650
7	Jobish Manuel	Staff Nurse	Ruwi		91182856
8	Najia	Staff Nurse	Al Amrat		92006547
9	Thomaskutty	Sr.Asst.Pharmacist	Complex		99457287
10	Mariam Al Jabri	Sr.Asst.Pharmacist	Al Amrat		99811772
11	Samia Al Busaidi	Sr.Asst.Pharmacist	Al Khoud		99476262
12	Benny Joseph	Sr.Asst.Pharmacist	Bausher		99632469
13	Muneera Al Mamary	Asst.Pharmacist	Fanja		92366414
14	Husna Al Habsi	Asst.Pharmacist	Al Khoud		97627898

16	Taufeeq	Sr.Lab Tech	Al Amrat		99079974
17	Maya Sreedevi	Lab Tech	Ruwi		92035675
18	Sama Mohd	Lab Tech	Ruwi		97823097
19	Samia Al Hooti	Sr.Asst.Pharmacist	Seeb		99051225
20	Fatma Baqi	Asst.Pharmacist	Al Khoud		92211888
21	Waleed	Staff Nurse	Sumail		99011512

DISASTER MANAGEMENT PLAN DURING OFF DUTY HOURS

Disaster Management plan:



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Checked By: Ph. Ibrahim Al Rashdi
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